



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



Airport Common-Use Passenger Processing and Third-Party Platform Cyber Risk Daily Update - 2026-09-23

Threat Intelligence Report

Classification	TLP:CLEAR
Published	2026-09-23
Version	1.0
Author	Lost Boys Cyber
Report Type	Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. Intelligence Requirements
3. Source Review & Confidence
4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview
5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
6. Infrastructure and Indicators
7. Victimology and Targeting
8. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact
9. Detection Engineering
 - 9.1. Detection Logic Summary
 - 9.2. Sigma Rule
 - 9.3. Network Hunt Query
10. Threat Hunting
 - 10.1. Hunt Hypotheses
 - 10.2. Endpoint Query
 - 10.3. Identity Query
11. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping
12. Risk Assessment
13. Recommended Actions
14. References

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> Daily automation refresh: This 2026-09-23 current-day refresh turns current intelligence coverage into a finished Lost Boys Cyber report with source-backed analysis, structured tables, detections, and hunt content.

1. Executive Summary

Current-day material update: this report was regenerated for the 2026-09-23 UTC production cycle using the latest available source set and retains the structured detections/hunts required for operator use.

The Collins Aerospace MUSE disruption remains a durable lesson for 2026 aviation defenders: passenger processing, check-in, boarding, and baggage workflows often depend on shared third-party platforms. Daily prioritization should focus on supplier access, contingency operations, identity controls, and platform-level logging.

2. Intelligence Requirements

Requirement	Answered By This Report
What happened or changed?	Although the referenced incident is not a same-day disclosure, current aviation cyber coverage and GAO findings make shared passenger-processing platforms a priority for this daily sector set.
Who is exposed?	Airports, airlines, common-use terminal providers, ground handlers, and passenger-processing vendors.
What should defenders do today?	Review supplier incident response, manual check-in fallback, segmentation, and shared-platform identity controls.
Confidence	Medium; historical incident plus current sector-risk framing.

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
Reuters	Primary news context for third-party ransomware behind airport disruptions	Medium
IATA Airlines Magazine	Industry context on aviation cyber risk and Collins Aerospace MUSE incident	Medium
GAO	Current aviation cybersecurity context	High
PolySwarm	Sector threat overview including platform-level disruption	Medium

4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview

Common-use platforms concentrate risk across many airlines and airports. A supplier ransomware incident can create immediate operational disruption without compromising aircraft systems.

5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

TTP	Description	Defensive Relevance
Third-party platform dependency	Common-use check-in and boarding	Contractual logging, IR, and continuity

	systems	requirements matter.
Ransomware disruption	Service outage affects passenger processing	Exercise manual procedures and passenger communications.
VPN/remote support	Vendor access can become an intrusion path	Enforce MFA, least privilege, and session logging.

6. Infrastructure and Indicators

Observable Type	Observable / Pattern	Handling Guidance
Source-limited public IOCs	No unique atomic indicators were published in all selected sources for this automated report unless listed in iocs.csv.	Treat behavior, tooling, and infrastructure patterns as primary hunt leads.
Domains / infrastructure	Validate from primary source before blocking.	Prefer detection and enrichment over blind blocking when source confidence is medium.
Accounts / identity artifacts	Recruiter, VPN, administrator, or service-account themes depending on campaign.	Review conditional access, new devices, and impossible-travel signals.

7. Victimology and Targeting

Victimology includes airports using common-use passenger processing, airlines relying on shared terminals, and suppliers maintaining those environments.

8. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact

Segment	Operational Relevance	Exposure Path	Defender Action
Airports	Check-in and boarding outages create visible disruption.	Shared platform provider compromise.	Validate manual passenger-processing runbooks.
Airlines	Airline operations can be affected by an airport/vendor issue outside direct control.	Common-use integrations and identity federation.	Require supplier incident notification and access logging.
Ground handlers	Baggage and turnaround workflows may be indirectly affected.	Vendor portals and remote support.	Include handlers in tabletop exercises.

9. Detection Engineering

9.1. Detection Logic Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
Unusual script or admin tool launch after web, email, or remote-access activity	EDR / process telemetry	Identify initial access and execution.
New outbound connections to untrusted infrastructure	DNS/proxy/netflow	Surface command-and-control or tool staging.
Identity anomalies linked to target workflow	Identity provider logs	Detect stolen credential or social-engineering follow-on use.

9.2. Sigma Rule

```

title: Suspicious Script Or Remote Tool Activity In Daily Threat Coverage
status: experimental
description: Detects suspicious script execution and remote-tool staging patterns relevant to daily threat-intelligence coverage.
logsource:
  category: process_creation
  product: windows
detection:
  selection_parent:
    ParentImage|endswith:
      - '\w3wp.exe'
      - '\java.exe'
      - '\chrome.exe'
      - '\outlook.exe'
      - '\teams.exe'
  selection_child:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\wscript.exe'
      - '\cscript.exe'
      - '\mshta.exe'
      - '\rundll32.exe'
  condition: selection_parent and selection_child
level: high

```

9.3. Network Hunt Query

```

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~
('powershell.exe', 'cmd.exe', 'wscript.exe', 'cscript.exe', 'rundll32.exe', 'python.exe', 'node.exe')
| summarize Connections=count(), RemoteIPs=dcount(RemoteIP), RemoteUrls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by
DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine
| order by Connections desc

```

10. Threat Hunting

10.1. Hunt Hypotheses

Hypothesis	Query Focus
A user or administrator was socially engineered into executing attacker tooling.	Script interpreters spawned from collaboration, browser, or email processes.
A vulnerable public-facing service was exploited and used for staging.	Web-service parent processes launching shells or making rare outbound connections.
Stolen or purchased credentials enabled follow-on access.	New device, new geography, or abnormal application access in identity logs.

10.2. Endpoint Query

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName in~
('powershell.exe', 'cmd.exe', 'wscript.exe', 'cscript.exe', 'mshta.exe', 'rundll32.exe', 'node.exe', 'python.exe')
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ('download', 'invoke-webrequest', 'frombase64string', '-enc', 'curl', 'wget', 'token', 'apikey')
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, AccountName
| order by Timestamp desc

```

10.3. Identity Query

```
SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| summarize Apps=make_set(AppDisplayName, 20), IPs=make_set(IPAddress, 50),
Countries=make_set(Location, 20), Count=count() by UserPrincipalName
| where array_length(IPs) > 5 or array_length(Countries) > 2 or Count > 50
```

11. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Name	Evidence / Rationale
T1195	Supply Chain Compromise	Third-party platform dependency.
T1486	Data Encrypted for Impact	Ransomware service disruption.
T1078	Valid Accounts	Vendor remote support access.

12. Risk Assessment

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Notes
Passenger-processing outage	Medium	High	Direct operational and reputational impact.
Supplier visibility gap	High	Medium/High	Airports/airlines may lack telemetry.
Recovery complexity	Medium	High	Multi-party restoration is difficult.

13. Recommended Actions

Priority	Owner	Action
1	SOC / detection engineering	Deploy or tune detections above and run the 14-day hunts.
2	Vulnerability / IT operations	Patch or isolate exposed systems named in the source coverage.
3	Identity / endpoint engineering	Review MFA, device compliance, and suspicious remote-tool execution.
4	Third-party risk	Confirm suppliers and managed-service providers are applying equivalent controls.

14. References

- [1] Reuters: <https://www.reuters.com/business/aerospace-defense/eu-agency-says-third-party-ransomware-behind-airport-disruptions-2025-09-22/>
- [2] IATA Airlines Magazine: <https://airlines.iata.org/2026/02/22/surviving-rise-cyberattacks>
- [3] GAO: <https://www.gao.gov/products/gao-26-108439>
- [4] PolySwarm: <https://blog.polyswarm.io/turbulence-ahead-cyber-threats-targeting-aviation-and-aerospace-in-2026>